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PARTH MANE

Even as the country celebrates a new high in shooting at the Olympics, a 16-year-old continues to bloom far away from the media spotlight.

For Parth Mane, it didn't matter that he was going up against the likes of Paris 2024 silver medallist Victor Lindgren and reigning junior Asian champion Huang Liwanlin in the 24-shot air rifle final of the Junior World Championship in September. For that moment in Mane's 'mind palace,' all he found was himself and the 10 rings located 10 metres up ahead. Eventually, he shot 250.7 to take home his first major international title.

Parth's compatriots Ajay Malik and Abhinav Shaw finished fifth and seventh, respectively, to help the India men's team finish top and claim a second gold.

Mane also opened his Junior World Cup account with a silver medal in Granada in 2024. At the Asian Championships in Jakarta, he won a bronze medal in the junior section of the 10m air rifle.